

BOOK 1 OF THE HOLLOW DOMINION

THE DREAMING GATE

A D&D 5e Adventure for Levels 1-3

3-4 Sessions | 3-5 Players

by **Helm Evans**

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ADVENTURE SUMMARY

A kingdom cursed by the death-throes of a dreaming god

BACKGROUND

Six months ago, the god Mordath — divine patron of dreams and the creator of the Hollow Dominion — foresaw his own death. In his terror, a fragment of his psyche split away and gained sentience: **The Architect**, a parasitic entity that wears Mordath's fear like a crown and seeks to consume his divine essence. As Mordath's life force drains away, his dying dreams spill into the mortal world, warping reality across the Hollow Dominion. The landscape twists, nightmare creatures emerge from thin points between worlds, and the populace is trapped in a kingdom that is slowly becoming a realm of endless nightmare.

The player characters are **Dreambound** — souls tethered to Mordath's fading consciousness by a shared vision that drew them to the Dominion. They cannot leave until the curse is broken, and if Mordath dies without resolution, they die with him. Their only hope is to find the **Three Keys** — fragments of Mordath's divine essence scattered across the Dominion — and use them to either save the god or end the curse before the Architect consumes everything.

The adventure spans **three parts**: arrival at the Ashen Gate and meeting the gatekeeper Eldon Voss; investigation in the town of Drearym, where faction tensions between the Waking Guard and Dreamseekers threaten to tear the town apart; and the climactic assault on the Gatehouse of Dreams, where the party must face the Nightmare Knight and enter Mordath's dying mind through the Dreaming Gate.

Adventure Details		Key NPCs	
System	D&D 5e	Eldon Voss	Gatekeeper, former captain
Levels	1-3	Capt. Ashford	Waking Guard commander
Sessions	3-4	Brother Caelum	Dreamseeker priest
Players	3-5	Marta Greel	Innkeeper, Lissa's mother
Tone	Dark fantasy mystery	Mordath	The Dreaming God (dying)
Play Time	8-12 hours	The Architect	Mordath's fear, main villain

Adventure Hook: The Shared Dream

For three nights running, each player character has experienced the same vivid dream: a vast chamber of white stone, lit by starlight that seems to come from everywhere and nowhere. At the center sits a figure on a throne, robed in shimmering fabric that shifts between midnight blue and deep purple. Its face is hidden behind a mask of cracked porcelain, and from behind it comes a voice — ancient, kind, and desperate.

"Come. Please. Before it is too late. I have seen my death, and it is not what you think. The hollow ones stir in my dreams. They wear my fear like a crown. Find the three keys — the Architect, the Crown, the Heart — before they consume everything. I cannot hold on much longer. Please."

On the fourth morning, each character discovers a mark on their skin — a glowing sigil shaped like an eye within a crescent moon. The sigil cannot be removed by any mundane or magical short of breaking the curse. It glows purple in darkness, burns warm near dream-energy, and marks the bearer as **Dreambound** — tethered to Mordath's fate. The characters find themselves drawn westward, following an instinct they cannot explain, toward a misty archway that has appeared where none existed before: the **Ashen Gate**, the entrance to the Hollow Dominion.

DM Note: The shared dream is Mordath's final attempt to reach beyond the Dominion for help. The Architect is aware of this and will attempt to intercept or corrupt the Dreambound before they can find the three keys. The sigil serves as both a curse (the characters cannot leave) and a tool (it grants Dreamsense — the ability to detect dream-energy within 30 feet).

FACTIONS OF THE HOLLOW DOMINION

The powers that shape the Dominion — allies, enemies, and those in between

THE WAKING GUARD *

Symbol: A golden sun over a crossed sword. **Leader:** Captain Rena Ashford. **Headquarters:** Drearym Barracks. **Strength:** 45 soldiers (12 in Drearym, 8 at the Outpost, 25 scattered across the Dominion). **Alignment:** Lawful Good.

The Waking Guard is the military force that has held the Hollow Dominion together since the curse began. They maintain order in Drearym, patrol the Twisted March, and protect the populace from nightmare creatures. They are underfunded, understaffed, and exhausted — but they refuse to give up. Captain Ashford's orders are simple: protect the people, keep the roads open, and do not engage the Dreamseekers unless provoked. The Guard views the Dreambound with sympathy — many guards have family members who are marked — but they follow orders without question.

Goals: Protect Drearym from nightmare creatures and the growing Unbound threat. Maintain the roads between settlements. Prevent the Dreamseekers from "killing the god" (which would doom all Dreambound). Find a way to break the curse without sacrificing Mordath.

Attitude toward the party: Cautiously welcoming. The Guard needs capable allies, but Captain Ashford will test the party's loyalty before trusting them with sensitive information. DC 12 Persuasion to gain the Guard's trust; DC 15 to access the armory or request reinforcements.

THE DREAMSEEKERS »

Symbol: A crescent moon with an eye at its center. **Leader:** Brother Caelum (unknowingly manipulated by The Architect). **Headquarters:** Old Town Chapel, Drearym. **Strength:** ~60 members (mix of Dreambound converts and desperate citizens). **Alignment:** Neutral (believe they are doing good).

The Dreamseekers are a religious movement that believes killing Mordath will end the curse and "free" the Dreambound. They are wrong — killing the god will kill every Dreambound, including the players — but they genuinely believe they are saving people. Brother Caelum, their charismatic leader, preaches that Mordath's death will release the Dreambound from their tether and allow them to leave the Dominion. In reality, The Architect is using Caelum to build an army of Unbound that will storm the Fractured Court and kill Mordath by force.

Goals: Convert Dreambound to their cause through "sharing circles" (secretly conversion rituals). Build an army of Unbound to assault the Fractured Court. Kill Mordath, believing this will free all Dreambound. The Architect's true goal: consume Mordath's divine essence and become a new god of nightmares.

Attitude toward the party: Hostile if the party opposes their goals. The Dreamseekers will attempt to convert the party through persuasion (DC 14 Persuasion or DC 13 WIS save to resist) or, failing that, eliminate them as threats. Brother Caelum will personally confront the party if they rescue Lissa or help the Waking Guard.

THE VEIL COURT □

Symbol: A silver crown over a purple veil. **Leader:** Queen Thessaly (missing, presumed dead). **Headquarters:** The Fractured Court (ruined capital). **Strength:** ~20 surviving nobles and their retainers. **Alignment:** Lawful Neutral.

The Veil Court is the remnants of the Hollow Dominion's nobility, clinging to power in the ruins of the capital city. They believe the curse is temporary and that Mordath will recover, restoring the Dominion to its former glory. They are isolated, paranoid, and increasingly desperate — nightmare creatures stalk the halls of their ruined palace, and their food supplies are running low. They have the Silver Key (the Crown) but do not know its true significance.

Goals: Survive until the curse ends. Maintain their authority over the Dominion's surviving settlements. Find Queen Thessaly (who disappeared into the Dreaming Depths three months ago). Protect the Crown, which they believe is a symbol of legitimate rule.

THE UNBOUND □

Symbol: None (they are mindless). **Leader:** None (controlled by The Architect through Brother Caelum). **Strength:** ~200 (and growing). **Alignment:** Chaotic Evil.

The Unbound are former Dreambound who have been fully consumed by nightmare energy. Their bodies are partially translucent and crumbling, their eyes glow purple, and they attack the living without mercy. They are created through the Dreamseekers' "sharing circles" — rituals that slowly drain a Dreambound's life force until they rise as Unbound. The Architect controls them through a psychic link, using them as soldiers in its army. They are most active at night and near thin points where dream-energy is strongest.

Goals: Serve The Architect. Convert more Dreambound into Unbound. Storm the Fractured Court and kill Mordath. The Unbound are not negotiable — they are mindless servants of The Architect's will.

FACTION NPCs & CREATURES

Stat blocks for key faction members and enemies

WAKING GUARD SOLDIER

MEDIUM HUMANOID (HUMAN), LAWFUL GOOD

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14	12	12	10	11	10
+2	+1	+1	+0	+0	+0

AC 16 (chain mail) | HP 11 (2d8+2) | Speed 30 ft.

Longsword. +4 to hit, 1d8+2 slashing. *Light Crossbow*. +3 to hit, 1d8 piercing, 80/320ft.

Shield Wall. If adjacent to another Guard with a shield, +1 AC.

CAPTAIN RENA ASHFORD

MEDIUM HUMANOID (HUMAN), LAWFUL GOOD

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16	12	14	10	14	13
+3	+1	+2	+0	+2	+1

AC 16 (chain mail, shield) | HP 45 (6d8+12) | Speed 30 ft.

Saves: STR +5, CON +4 | Skills: Athletics +5, Intimidation +3, Perception +4

Longsword. +5 to hit, 1d8+3 slashing. *Signal Horn (1/day)*. Summons 2d4 Guards in 1d4 rounds.

DREAMSEEKER ACOLYTE

MEDIUM HUMANOID (HUMAN), NEUTRAL

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10	12	10	12	14	14
+0	+1	+0	+1	+2	+2

AC 11 (leather) | HP 9 (2d8) | Speed 30 ft.

Spellcasting (Cleric 1): DC 12, +4 to hit. *Cantrips*: guidance, sacred flame. *1st (2 slots)*: command, cure wounds.

Convert (1/day). One willing Dreambound touched must DC 13 WIS save or gain 1 level of exhaustion (3 levels = becomes Unbound).

BROTHER CAELUM

MEDIUM HUMANOID (HUMAN), NEUTRAL

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10	12	10	14	16	18
+0	+1	+0	+2	+3	+4

AC 13 (chain shirt) | HP 32 (5d8+10) | Speed 30 ft.

Skills: Deception +6, Insight +5, Persuasion +8, Religion +4

Spellcasting (Cleric 5): DC 13, +5 to hit. *Cantrips*: guidance, sacred flame, thaumaturgy. *1st (4)*: command, cure wounds, sanctuary, shield of faith. *2nd (3)*: hold person, spiritual weapon, augury. *3rd (2)*: spirit guardians, dispel magic.

Dreamseeker's Blessing: *Detect thoughts* at will (bonus action). Granted by The Architect.

THE UNBOUND

MEDIUM UNDEAD, CHAOTIC EVIL

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10	6	14	6	8	8
+0	-2	+2	-2	-1	-1

AC 12 | HP 22 (4d8+4) | Speed 30 ft.

Resist: Acid, Cold, Fire, Lightning, Thunder; B/P/S nonmagical

Immune: Necrotic, Poison; Charmed, Exhaustion, Frightened, Poisoned

Slam. +4 to hit, 2d6+2 psychic damage. Mindless: Immune to charm, fright, and psychic damage from non-Architect sources.

PART 1: THE ASHEN GATE

The entrance to the Hollow Dominion — and the point of no return

DANGER



ARRIVAL

"The archway rises from the mist like a broken tooth. Once-grand stone, now cracked and leaking purple dream-energy that makes your sigil burn warm. Beyond the gate, trees grow sideways and the road shifts when you're not looking."

The Ashen Gate is the only known entrance. Passing through is one-way. Characters who touch the purple energy must make a DC 12 WIS save or experience a brief vision of Mordath's throne room.



Eldon Voss — The Gatekeeper, former captain of the Waking Guard

ENCOUNTER: ELDON VOSS, THE GATEKEEPER

An old man sits on a mossy stone beside the gate, whittling with a rusted knife. His guard captain's uniform is tattered but the golden sun insignia is still visible. His eyes are sharp despite the grey stubble and thousand-yard stare. He looks up as you approach, gaze locking onto your glowing sigils.

"You're Dreambound. Welcome to the nightmare, friends. Mind the roads after dark. Things come through from the Dreaming Depths when the sun goes down."

Eldon is a font of information — but his mind is fractured. He drifts between lucid moments and confused rambling. When focused, he provides detailed directions, warns about thin points, and explains faction tensions. When confused, he relives battles from six months ago.

- ♦ The Dominion has been cursed for six months
- ♦ The landscape warps unpredictably — paths change, distances stretch
- ♦ Nightmare creatures emerge at dusk from thin points
- ♦ The Waking Guard maintain order; the Dreamseekers want Mordath dead
- ♦ "Don't sleep near running water — that's where the nightmares come through strongest."
- ♦ The Dreamseekers are "harvesting" Dreambound — converting them into Unbound

Social: DC 12 Persuasion for specific info. DC 10 Insight for lucid vs. rambling. Kindness (food, healing, respect) earns a hand-drawn map (advantage on Survival checks during travel).

DM NOTE

Eldon was once a respected captain. The curse broke his mind but fragments of wisdom remain. If hostile, he becomes incoherent. If trusted, he becomes a recurring source of information and can send messages to Captain Ashford.

THE TWISTED MARCH

Three days through nightmare-ravaged countryside



THE TWISTED ROAD

The road from the Ashen Gate to Drearym is called the Twisted March — a three-day journey through forest warped by Mordath's dying dreams. Trees grow at impossible angles, streams run purple with dream-energy, and distances change with the time of day. The air feels thick and wrong. Sounds carry strangely — a whisper echoes for miles, a shout is swallowed by mist. The party's Dreambound sigils burn warmer as they travel deeper. Travel is slow: 12 miles per day. Paths loop back on themselves, hills rise and fall like breathing things, and the stars rearrange into patterns that hurt to look at.

DAY 1 — THE WAKING GUARD OUTPOST

Halfway through the first day, the party reaches a fortified camp. Sergeant Dara Voss (Eldon's niece) commands 4 guards. She offers safe rest, rations, and information. She confirms the Dreamseekers are "recruiting" Dreambound — and those who join don't come back the same. She warns about the Wellspring: "We lost two men there last week. Whatever's in that well, it pulls you in."

DAY 2 — THE RUINED TOWER OF VALDRIS

A wizard's tower consumed by dream-energy. The stone walls shift between solid rock and translucent purple crystal. DC 14 Investigation finds a hidden journal page: "*Mordath spoke to us in dreams. 'I have seen my death. The Architect stirs in my dreams. It wants to wear my crown.'*" DC 12 Arcana reveals the thin point here is growing stronger.

DAY 3 — APPROACHING DREARYM

The final day is the most dangerous. The warping intensifies, and the party may encounter Unbound shambling through the trees. Drearym's walls appear on the horizon by late afternoon. The guards at the gate are wary, and the party's Dreambound marks will be noted.

D	8	
E	v	e n t
1	Shifting Path: DC 12 Survival or lose 1d4 hours + 1 exhaustion.	
2	Dream Echo: DC 13 WIS or 1 exhaustion.	
3	Nightmare Wolf: Attacks from treeline. Flees at half HP.	
4	Traveler: Refugee warns about Dreamseeker harvesting.	
5	Dream Shimmer: Find the three keys. DC 14 WIS or 2d6 psychic.	
6	Waking Guard Outpost: Safe rest, rations, information.	
7	Thin Point: DC 13 CON or pulled into dream vision.	
8	Peaceful Stretch: Recover 1 exhaustion, short rest.	

MAP: THE TWISTED MARCH

Regional map — Ashen Gate to Drearym



The Twisted March — Forest clearing with purple pools marking thin points between worlds.

LANDMARKS
◆ Ashen Gate (South): Entry point. Meet Eldon Voss. ◆ Waking Guard Outpost: Day 1. Sgt. Dara Voss, 4 guards. Safe haven. ◆ The Wellspring: Day 1-2. Ancient well leaking purple energy. Rescue Lissa. ◆ Ruined Tower of Valdris: Day 2. Hidden journal page. Growing thin point. ◆ Purple Pools: Thin points. Nightmare creatures emerge after dark. ◆ Drearym (North): Day 3. First major town. Faction tensions.

PART 2: THE TOWN OF DREARYM

A town on the edge of collapse

DANGER



ARRIVAL

"Drearym was once a prosperous market town of 2,000. Now it holds perhaps 800. A makeshift wall of sharpened logs surrounds the town. Purple mist hovers in the alleys. Some buildings lean at impossible angles."

The town is under martial law. The Waking Guard controls the gates. The party's Dreambound marks will be noted.

A — THE VIGOROUS DOG (INN)

A ramshackle two-story building with a painted sign of a running dog. Marta Greel runs the place with a hand crossbow under the bar. Rooms 5sp/night. She offers 50gp for her daughter Lissa, missing near the Wellspring for three days. Marta is a former adventurer who lost her leg to a nightmare creature. "If you find my girl, bring her home."

B — WAKING GUARD BARRACKS

Fortified stone building flying the Waking Guard's sun banner. Captain Rena Ashford commands 12 soldiers. She asks the party to investigate nightmare sightings (30gp reward). She warns about Brother Caelum. Locked armory (DC 15) contains spare weapons and a *Potion of Healing*.

C — OLD TOWN CHAPEL

Once a house of worship, now the Dreamseekers' meeting place. Brother Caelum preaches that killing Mordath will "free" the Dreambound. He's being manipulated by The Architect. Secret basement (DC 14 Perception) has a ritual chamber for "sharing circles" — conversion rituals that create Unbound.

DREARYM — KEY LOCATIONS

Town map and location details

D — MARKET SQUARE
Central gathering place. Notice board with missing persons flyers (including Lissa's), bounties, and Dreamseeker recruitment. Refugee camp in the eastern corner. A hooded figure (DC 14 Perception) watches the party — a Dreamseeker spy reporting to Caelum.
E — THE WELLSPRING
Ancient stone well outside the eastern wall, leaking purple dream-energy. Lissa Greel sits at the edge, trapped in a Dream Loop. 2 Nightmare Spawn guard the well. Within 10ft = difficult terrain. Within 5ft = DC 12 WIS or pulled toward well. Well is 15ft deep, filled with glowing purple liquid.
F — NORTH GATE
Main entrance, controlled by the Waking Guard. Two guards check everyone. Curfew after sunset. DC 12 Persuasion to pass without full inspection. Gate is reinforced with iron bands.



Drearym — Letters mark key locations. Purple water flows through the settlement.

NPCs OF THE DOMINION

The god, the captain, the priest, and the innkeeper



Mordath — The Dreaming God, his divine form crumbling



Captain Rena Ashford — Commander of the Waking Guard



Brother Caelum — Dreamseeker priest, manipulated by The Architect



Marta Greel — Innkeeper, former adventurer, mother of Lissa

MARTA GREEL & THE DREAMING WELL

The innkeeper, the missing girl, and the nightmare spawn

MARTA GREEL — INNKEEPER

MEDIUM HUMANOID (HUMAN), CHAOTIC GOOD

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14	10	16	12	13	11
+2	+0	+3	+1	+1	+0

AC 12 | HP 27 (5d8+5) | Speed 20 ft. (peg leg)

Skills: Intimidation +2, Medicine +3, Survival +4

Equipment: Hand crossbow (+4, 1d6 piercing), peg leg (improvised, +4, 1d4+2)

ENCOUNTER: THE DREAMING WELL

Option 1 — Physical Pull: DC 14 STR. DC 13 WIS or stunned.

Option 2 — Enter the Dream: DC 13 WIS. DC 13 Persuasion. Failure = 2d6 psychic.

Option 3 — Disrupt: DC 14 Arcana. Success = Spawn take 3d6 radiant.



Nightmare Spawn — Shadow creatures that drain the life force

NIGHTMARE SPAWN (RESKINNED SHADOW)

MEDIUM UNDEAD, CHAOTIC EVIL

AC 12 | HP 16 (3d8+3) | Speed 40 ft.

Strength Drain. +4 to hit, 2d6+2 psychic. STR -1d4. STR 0 = Unbound in 1d4 rounds.

Nightmare Aura: 10ft, DC 11 WIS or frightened. Amorphous, Shadow Stealth

PART 3: THE GATEHOUSE OF DREAMS

The boundary between worlds

DANGER



The Gatehouse of Dreams — Ancient monastery consumed by dream-energy

THE GATEHOUSE

A fortress built into a sheer cliff — the last outpost before the boundary dissolves into Mordath's consciousness. Purple dream-stuff seeps through cracks, pooling on floors that shift between rock and liquid starlight. The central courtyard's fountain bubbles endlessly. The air is thick with psychic residue — whispers of Mordath's dreams, visions of things to come. Dreamsense is amplified: all Dreambound within 60ft detected. After 1 hour inside, DC 12 WIS or 1 exhaustion from psychic strain.

THE FOUR WINGS

- ◆ **Dormitory (West):** DC 13 Investigation: journal page about The Architect.
- ◆ **Library (North):** Mordath was a mortal who ascended. The Architect is his fear.
- ◆ **Chapel (East):** 3 Nightmare Spawn. DC 13 WIS or vision of Mordath pleading.
- ◆ **Gate Hall (South):** The Dreaming Gate — portal to Mordath's throne room.

THE GATE HALL

"The Gate Hall opens onto the cliff edge. Before you stands the Dreaming Gate — thirty feet tall, filled with swirling purple energy. Through the portal: a white throne room. On the throne sits a figure robed in starlight, mask of cracked porcelain. Dying."

Between you and the portal stands a figure in purple armor, twin blades of crackling pink energy. It does not speak. But you feel its sorrow.

BOSS: THE NIGHTMARE KNIGHT

Guardian of the Dreaming Gate

DANGER



The Nightmare Knight — Dreambound soul with twin energy blades

THE GUARDIAN

A Dreambound soul — not evil, merely bound by duty. Social: DC 15 Persuasion (DC 12 if Lissa rescued).
Success: "The god is dying. What you do in there will determine whether the Dominion lives or dies." Combat:
Hard for level 3. Surrenders at 20 HP.

NIGHTMARE KNIGHT

MEDIUM UNDEAD, LAWFUL NEUTRAL

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18	14	18	12	14	16
+4	+2	+4	+1	+2	+3

AC 15 | HP 85 (10d8+40) | Speed 30 ft.

Multiattack. Two Energy Blades: +7, 2d6+4 slashing + 1d8 psychic.

Life Drain (Recharge 5-6). +7, 3d6+4 psychic, heals half. **Dream Step (Bonus).** Teleport 30ft.

Parry (Reaction). +3 AC. **Legendary (1/round): Reposition.** Move 15ft.

TOUCHING THE GATE

"The world dissolves into white. 'Three keys. Find them. The Architect wears my fear like a crown. The Crown lies in the Fractured Court. The Heart beats in the Dreaming Depths. Please. I cannot hold on much longer.'"

Each character gains Dreamsense (30ft, always active).

END OF BOOK 1

Mordath, the Three Keys, and the cliffhanger for Book 2

MORDATH — THE DYING GOD Through the Dreaming Gate, the party has glimpsed the truth: Mordath is not the enemy. He is a dying god — once a mortal who ascended to divinity through collective dreams, now consumed by his own fear of death. His curse is not malicious; it is a divine fever dream, the death-throes of a god who foresaw his own end. The purple dream-energy leaking into the Hollow Dominion is his life force, draining away as he fades. Mordath's final message: three keys can resolve the curse. "The Architect wears my fear like a crown. The Crown lies in the Fractured Court. The Heart beats in the Dreaming Depths." These are fragments of Mordath's divine essence — his authority (the Architect/Crown), his sovereignty (the Fractured Court), and his compassion (the Heart/Dreaming Depths).								
THE THREE KEYS The Bronze Key — The Architect: Mordath's own fear of death, given sentience. It manipulates the Dreamseekers through Brother Caelum to build an army. The Bronze Key can only be claimed by confronting the source of Mordath's fear. <i>Book 2: The Fractured Court.</i> The Silver Key — The Crown: Mordath's symbol of divine authority, lying in the ruins of the capital. Guarded by twisted former courtiers. <i>Book 3.</i> The Gold Key — The Heart: Mordath's divine compassion, beating in the Dreaming Depths beyond the waking world. Protected by the most powerful nightmare creatures and Mordath's own despair. <i>Book 4.</i>								
CLIFFHANGER FOR BOOK 2 "As you leave the Gatehouse, you see them. A vast army of Unbound — hundreds strong — marching toward Drearym. At their head: Brother Caelum, eyes glowing purple. He's been converting Dreambound into Unbound, building an army to storm the Fractured Court and kill Mordath by force. And he's coming for you next." The party must return to Drearym and warn Captain Ashford — but the army is only days away. The race to find the three keys has begun. If the Architect reaches Mordath first, the god dies, every Dreambound perishes, and the Hollow Dominion becomes a realm of endless nightmare.								
TREASURE & REWARDS <table><tr><td>Guardian's Longsword (<i>uncommon</i>)</td></tr><tr><td>+1 longsword. +1d4 psychic vs undead/fiends. 1/day: <i>detect thoughts</i> (DC 13).</td></tr><tr><td>Marta's Gratitude</td></tr><tr><td>If Lissa rescued: <i>Potion of Greater Healing</i> + <i>Cloak of Elvenkind</i>.</td></tr><tr><td>Monastery Journal</td></tr><tr><td>25gp. DC 15 History reveals Fractured Court location.</td></tr><tr><td>Dreambound Sigil</td></tr><tr><td>Identify Dreambound. Advantage on saves vs nightmare effects.</td></tr></table> Milestone: Party reaches level 3.	Guardian's Longsword (<i>uncommon</i>)	+1 longsword. +1d4 psychic vs undead/fiends. 1/day: <i>detect thoughts</i> (DC 13).	Marta's Gratitude	If Lissa rescued: <i>Potion of Greater Healing</i> + <i>Cloak of Elvenkind</i> .	Monastery Journal	25gp. DC 15 History reveals Fractured Court location.	Dreambound Sigil	Identify Dreambound. Advantage on saves vs nightmare effects.
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GM NOTES Tone: Waking up in someone else's nightmare. Mordath is not a villain — he's a dying god. Moral Complexity: Neither faction is wrong. The Guard wants to preserve Mordath. The Dreamseekers want to end the curse. Both conflict with player survival. Scaling: Level 1: Knight HP 60, no Legendary Actions. Level 4+: +2 Nightmare Spawn, Knight +10 HP.								

THE HOLLOW DOMINION

A once-prosperous kingdom cursed by the death-throes of Mordath, the Dreaming God. His nightmares leak into the waking world — twisting landscapes, corrupting creatures, and driving the populace mad.

The players are Dreambound — souls tethered to Mordath's fading consciousness. They cannot leave until the curse is broken. But if Mordath dies, they die with him.

From the Ashen Gate to the Gatehouse of Dreams, the party must navigate nightmare-ravaged lands, choose which faction to trust, and find the three keys that can save the Dominion — or doom it forever.

D&D 5e | Levels 1-3 | 3-4 Sessions | 3-5 Players

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